

conserving the natural environment. Green technology also tends to minimize and reduce the negative impact caused by human activities such as manufacturing or disposing of gadgets, which may in any way lead to the degradation of the environment.

## Current problems faced

Human population is growing at an exponential rate. We have crossed the 7 billion mark already and will reach around 9 billion by 2050. We have already inhabited 80 per cent of the planet's surface, so clearly, the habitable area will not be increasing as exponentially as the global population. To accommodate a higher population, more forests will have to be sacrificed. Will there be enough resources to fulfill the needs of that kind of population if we continue to consume energy the way we are today? Estimates say that we will need the resources of almost three Earth's to support the population in 2050. Add to this, the increased industrialization and increased consumerism, how do we ensure that our activities do not harm the environment?

Loss of biodiversity, habitat destruction, depletion of energy and mineral sources, environmental pollution, species extinction, ozone-layer depletion are some of the problems that are staring us in the face. Studies and scientific research on environmental degradation has time and again stressed on the fact that we have few years left to change the way we live, preserve our depleting eco-systems, reduce emission of greenhouse gases. If we are not cognizant of these signs, we are staring at a doomed future.

